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The autonomy granted to the individual in terms of free speech can be both individual (understood purely from the speaker's point of view) and relational in nature.

The individual's speech must be protected in order to allow them to freely develop their personality.

This is important, even bearing in mind that this development is only possible in social life, which means in relation to and possibly in cooperation with others.

Relational autonomy, however, also takes the interests of the audience of the speech into account.

Speech can also limit the autonomy of others, for example in the case of defamation, invasion of privacy, or hate speech that hurts certain community.

European legal systems also take the latter aspect into account when setting the limits of freedom of expression.

They restrict freedom of expression in the interests of the autonomy of those affected by the speech, in order to ensure the peace and security of social coexistence.